A Typical Day

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/41392032.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Adora & Catra & Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Unnamed Assassins

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by tjsthelifeofice

Summary

Someone tries to assassinate Catra, but it turns out they were actually trying to assassinate Adora. Little not-quite-baby Finn meets Bow and Glimmer for the first time. Little Finn weaponizes a pool noodle to get cookies.

Catra knew that there were assassins after her. Honestly she was surprised they hadn't come sooner. They were the kind of assassins that were well practiced in hunting down humans and similar creatures. They hid in the darkness, unaware of Catra's low light vision and superior sense of smell.

She didn't want Finn to have to see her get in a fight, so she wrote a note on a napkin before passing it to Adora.

"You have something on your face," She explained. Adora moved to clean this nonexistent stain before noticing the note on the napkin.

Someone's hiding in our house. Send Finn somewhere safe, we may have to get in a fight and I don't want them involved. Adora's eyes widened.

"Hey, Finn? There's someone I want you to meet." Adora discreetly called Glimmer. Didn't tell her much, only hat there was danger, Finn needed to be protected, and they weren't supposed to know about said danger.

Bow and Glimmer knew about Finn at this point, but they hadn't met in person yet. Finn had only recently been adopted.

"Who is it? You guys aren't sending me away, are you…?" Finn seemed unsure of this.

"No we're not. But we have some friends who were very excited to meet you. They just stopped into town, and they were hoping you could visit for a bit. Your aunt… Sparkle, and your uncle… King!" Catra said. Adora hurriedly sent their two friends the names of their false identities.

"Is uncle King actually a king?" Finn asked innocently.

"Um… I'll let you tell him that yourself!" There was a knock at the door. Glimmer must have teleported them right there. "OH! That'd be them!" Adora opened the door to reveal Bow and Glimmer in

hastily thrown together civilian outfits, which were basically just the long hooded robes they'd used back when they were pretending not to be princesses when Prime attacked. Except now they were tie dyed.

"Oh sweet and merciful Saz." Catra said, hiding her face in her hands.

"Oh! These people look cool!" Baby Finn said, running up to shake hands with both newcomers. "My name's Finn, I'm a magicat and I just got adopted by Cat and Addie who are my new moms and they also have a cat named Melog who likes me a lot. I like desserts because I have to win a game against Cat to get them and the games are a lot of fun, especially the floor is lava. But we do other games too and they're also fun! Like pillow fights and checkers!"

"Oh my goodness! Why didn't you tell me your kid was so CUTE!" Bow squealed.

"Because that would be spoilers." Catra said quickly. "Remember why you came here. Time's a-wasting, remember?" Bow seemed to suddenly remember the solemn circumstances of their summoning.

"OH! Right, We needed to go do… a *thing!* " Bow said.

"What kind of thing?" Finn asked.

"It's a… surprise?" Bow said.

"Yeah! A surprise!" Glimmer said cheerily. "Come on, we've got so much to talk about on the way!" They led Finn out of the house and slammed the door behind them.

Catra and Adora's facades dropped immediately.

"Alright folks. We know you're hiding. If you were planning on a sneak attack, don't bother. We already know you're here, so if you could come out and fight us, go ahead."

“Oh, the little kitty’s smart, isn’t she? Found out we’re here. Well if you’re smart enough to figure *that* out, maybe you’re smart enough to realize the situation you’re in. It’s six against two. You can’t protect blondie over there from all of us, and it’d *really* suck if your kid got orphaned twice. So just give her up, and we’ll let you live.”

Catra was dumbstruck. These people were after *Adora!?* Why would anyone want to murder *She-Ra?* Catra had assumed that the assassins were for *her.* Apparently not. These weren’t some righteous avengers seeking justice, they were just douchebags.

“Why the hell does anyone want to murder my wife!?”

“Hey, some lizard gave us some good stuff in exchange for her head. Now if you could wait outside, we’ll take care of your little sweetheart and then you can go back to living your happy life with your kid. Just tell them that their other mom went to play on a nice farm upstate to play with all the other moms or something.”

“First off, no. Second off, Adora, if you don’t mind?”

“I most certainly do *not!* Ahem. For the honor… of GREYSKULL!” There was a bright glow that spread from Adora’s feet to her head, and a symphony of brass instruments. The failsafe mark flickered to life on her chest, symbolizing that *all* the magic in the planet flowed through her and bent to her whim and will.

“...Fuck. That’s… that’s She-Ra, isn’t it?” one of the goons said.

“Yes. I married She-Ra. The best thing about it is I’m married to Adora. The worst thing is she keeps trying to sacrifice herself for the greater good. So are you gonna attack us or…?”

The mercenaries all allowed their weapons to clatter to the ground.

“Okay good choice. Now who wants to have tea while they’re being interrogated?” Catra asked.

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"So, when you mentionned desserts earlier, you said something weird about how you get them."

"Well, Cat likes baking, so there's always something sweet in the house. But when she asked for some, she said I had to earn them through training, which I hated until I found out how fun training was."

"Training? What do you mean by that?"

"So the first time she did my favorite one. She pretended to be evil, and she said something like 'brave hero, I have stolen your precious cookies! And you can't get to me because I have used this ray to turn the floor into lava! Mwahaha!' So I went over to her without touching the floor by jumping on these pillows she'd put down, but then I lost my balance and I stepped on the ground by accident, so I had to go back to the beginning. I pretended I was burning in the lava at first, but mom really didn't like that."

"That sounds like a lot of fun. What else do you do?" Bow asked.

"Well, just recently she got these really soft pillows that she can use to throw at me without hurting me, and if she gets me with one then I have to go to the start again. And sometimes when she's too tired to set up a path for me to jump through then we just play checkers or something. But she still pretends to be evil."

"...You know, part if this is surprising, but it really shouldn't be," Glimmer said contemplatively.

"What do you mean?"

"That's a story for your moms to tell you, when they want to. It's kinda sad, but it's got a happy ending," Bow explained.
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“Hey, you guys enjoy your burgers. I need to head to the bathroom real quick, okay?” Glimmer said, before heading for the *restroom* sign.

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“We never saw his face. He just called himself ‘the Dragon.’ He didn’t pay in money, but he had access to mint quality First-Ones’ tech, and a lot of it. The stuff we couldn’t use ourselves we were able to sell for… well, money.”

“Did ‘the Dragon’ tell you why he was after me?” Adora asked.

“He didn’t even tell us who you were! You gotta believe me, I don’t wanna die, I’m telling the truth!” The others in the group nodded along.

“Can any of you tell us *anything* important? Because if you don’t… we’re going to have to get rid of you.”

“ *Catra.* ”

“ *What?* I was only telling them that they’d have to leave!”

“You were implying that we’d murder them.”

“Well *duh.* That’s what they’re *supposed* to think, so they’re scared enough to talk. I mean I wouldn’t actually kill them, that’d be hypocritical.”

“Why would that be hypocritical?” One of them asked.

“Because I’m Catra. Any other nosy questions?” Those present, other than Adora, were suddenly less sure that she wouldn’t kill them.

Glimmer suddenly materialized in the room.
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“Hey, is it safe to bring Finn back? I- who are these guys?”

“Assassins. I thought they were after me, but apparently they were sent after *Adora.* ”

“What, really?”

“I don’t know, I fought a lot of people! Maybe they were hired by Horde sympathizers or anti-magic offworlders, or-”

“Well whoever it is I want to knock some sense into them. Or murder them. Depends on how bad they are. What should I do with these guys?”

“I don’t know. One one hand, they tried to kill Adora. Which is bad. On the other hand, *I* tried to kill Adora. Which is bad. And for some reason I’m not in jail or anything, so I don’t really know what the Rebellion does about stuff like this. Ask Adora.”

“I really don’t know what Bright moon punishments are so?”

“I can assassinate my *own* enemies, thank you very much.” Glimmer said. “So for the most part on Bright Moon, we punish people with community service. The worse the crime, the more important the service. So shoplifters have to pick up litter for a week, and world destroyers like us have to keep fixing everything wrong with the universe for the rest of our goddamn lives.”

“So where does attempted murder fall on that scale?” Adora asked.

“Well, attempted murder is like giving someone a bad gift: It’s the thought that counts. In this case, they *thought* they were going to end the life of She-Ra, the Princess of Power.”

“Hey, we didn’t know she was She-Ra!” One of the mercenaries protested.

“Okay, so they thought they were murdering a housewife and mother who was unarmed at the time.” Glimmer amended.

“Shut it, that’s even worse!”

“No it ain’t! She Ra’s important!”

“I think it’s pronounced She-Ra?”

“How the fuck did you just pronounce a hyphen?”

“Isn’t a hyphen the part of the body that breaks if-”

“No it aint! It’s the thing that smooshes two words together!”

“WILL YOU SHUT IT!” Glimmer yelled. “You know what, I’ll deal with this…” Pink glitter filled the room, leaving Catra and Adora alone in their living room.

“So that was weird.” Glimmer appeared again unnoticed to both.

“Yeah, it was.” Adora paused. “...Is now a weird time to say I want in on the ‘evil mom’ games?”

“No, not at all. Do you know why I made those games?”

“Because it’s nice to get in touch with that side of you sometimes?”

“Well, that, and because… a part of me is scared shitless that something bad’s gonna happen to them, and for some reason they’re not gonna have us to save them. So I used this as a way to kind of… train them. Back in the Horde, they said if we didn’t do well in training we wouldn’t get rations. That sucks. But according to a lot of things I read, you’re supposed to give kids desserts when they do something good, so I thought, *hey, why not use these to teach this kid how to get out of danger without being a horrible mom?* So I’ve been teaching them balance, agility, how to dodge projectiles”

“Huh. I didn’t know you felt that way about it, but that’s… kinda why I wanted to join too. I wanted to teach them swordfighting.”

“How are we gonna avoid them getting hit with the sword? That seems like a problem. According to Bow, you’re not the best with sword safety.”

“Well you use pillows, right? I saw these weird long pillows on a mattress store the other day.”

“I’ll never get over how the Rebellion has stores just for *mattresses.* But I digress. You know those things are floppy as hell, right? How are you gonna get them to stay straight?”

“You guys have been training Finn to fight?” Glimmer said. Catra and Adora jumped.

“Well… um… basically, yeah.” Catra confessed.

“Why did you say it as if that was a bad thing?”

“I don’t know, because it feels like I’m- that the kid *shouldn’t* be learning to fight. They’re a kid, they should get to do kid stuff, not being a soldier when there isn’t even a war anymore.”

“They *are* doing kid stuff. Kids do stuff like that all the time. I played ‘the floor is lava’ all the time with Bow. We climbed trees and fell off of them. We got into tickle fights.”

“Hey, that last one sounds like it’d be a great way to teach them to use their claws!” Catra pointed out.

“Point is, the only difference between what Finn’s doing and what any other kid’s gonna do is that they’re gonna be better at it, because you two take that stuff seriously. And who can blame you for being worried about Finn? You had to fight off six assassins today.”

“Technically we didn’t fight them. Adora just transformed and they shat themselves.”

“Still doesn’t change the fact that someone’s got it out for you and broke into your house to end lives. That's as good a reason as any

for teaching your kid how to scrap. I still don't get why anyone wants to kill Adora though."

"She came up with a few ideas. But if you want my advice, interrogate the assassins harder. Truth spell maybe. They lied to us."

"Wait, how do you know they were lying?

"They said that their boss was called 'the Dragon,' and they never saw his face, but one of them called him a lizard. That means two things. Firstly, he's probably a lizardfolk. Secondly, his goons know more but they don't want to incur his wrath."

"So… a lizardfolk with access to enough First One's tech to hand it out like party favors has it out for Adora specifically, *knows where we live,* and calls himself 'the Dragon…' sounds like it should narrow it down, but I don't think I met anyone like that," Glimmer puzzled.

"Neither have I. I think maybe it's working for, like some surviving group of the First Ones? Because I know Prime was supposed to have wiped them out, right, but then I'm here, so then that means that I came from somewhere, but then the First Ones were evil because they turned the planet into a bomb so what if they want to kill me for turning it into not-a-bomb?"

"That… actually sounds reasonable. Despite all the babbling."

"Thank you, Catra."

"Okay. So what you're saying is the magitech maniacs that made the thing I used to destroy the world once are back and also trying to kill you. Why the fuck not at this point. I'll go bring Finn back to y'all, and then I'm telling the resto of the princesses to look out for suspiciously attractive blondes that *aren't* you." Glimmer vanished.

"Suspiciously attractive? What's *that* supposed to mean?"

"Nothing, I hope. Wait, I just thought of an idea for how to teach Finn swordfighting. Let me just text Glimmer..."

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"So why'd you buy the pool noodles Aunt Sparkle?"

"Well, your moms wanted to try something new for the dessert thing, and they're gonna need these."

"Why?"

"You'll see."

As Finn entered the door, they saw that the furniture in the living room had been rearranged. It didn't look like a good lava course though, it looked more like someone had tried to get the couch and the chairs out of the way and the fireplace blocked. Catra picked up one of the pool noodles and handed it to the befuddled Finn, and gave the other to Adora.

"Hey kid, wanna cookie?" Catra asked.

"Yes yes yes yes!" Catra immediately went evil-mode.

"*Purrr*fect. Then our goals are aligned. *Fur* now."

"Cat puns. You truly are despicable."

"That… *goody two shoes* is guarding all the cookies, and won't let me have any! How rude. But *you* have skill. I admit that you're stronger than me, and more cunning. So how about a deal. I gave you this sword. You use it to take down the guard, and then we'll have all the *deliciousness* of the cookies to *ourselves!* Tehahaha!" Catra noticed that Bow was recording this whole thing on the tech pad. She wondered when he'd picked it up.
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“Okay… so how do I win?” Finn asked.

“It is my duty to guard these cookies until I find someone… worthy enough to take them from me. For every blow you land upon me, I will concede *one* cookie to Cat.”

“Hey! But then *she’ll* eat my cookie!”

“I won’t. But if *Addie* gets *you…* I will. But only one for each attack. When the jar is empty, you may have whatever is left.”

“Psst. Is a whole jar of cookies really healthy for a kid?” Glimmer whispered.

“It’s not full. I just use a big jar to make the goal seem important. There’s only a handful of cookies in there, and they’re pretty small.” Catra whispered back.

“Got it.”

“Now go, my minion of darkness and evil! Make those cookies *miiiine!”*

“I will do what I must.” Adora responded, solemnly readying her pool noodle.

Finn let loose a savage battle cry and charged into the fray. It occurred to those who were present, or those who had seen the video after the fact, that if Finn kept this spirit later in life that they would do just fine.

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